Handout 05.14: Fast Fashion Facts and the Consumer Comparison Task

Name: _____ Date: _____ Station: _____

Word bank: waste, water, repair, donate, price Turkish: atık, su, tamir, bağışlamak, fiyat Portuguese: resíduo, água, consertar, doar, preço Spanish: residuo, agua, reparar, donar, precio

LSA

Page 1. Day 1: how fast fashion works

The four features

Feature	What it means	What I can see on a garment
Speed		
Volume		
Price		
Thin construction		

Three costs that are not on the price tag

Cost	In my own words
Labor	
Water	
Waste	

The other side

Write the two honest points the class named out loud.

Page 2. Day 1: the journey of one sweatshirt

The eight cards (cut these apart, one set per station)

CARD: WORN Somebody buys the sweatshirt and wears it. This is where every garment starts. How many times it gets worn is the whole question.

CARD: DONATION BIN OR THRIFT SHOP The owner is done with it. It goes in a bin, a bag to a charity, or straight to a resale shop.

CARD: SORTING CENTER A person picks it up, looks at it, and decides what it is worth. Most donated clothing is sorted by hand, by grade and by type. This is where almost everything goes next, and almost nobody knows it.

CARD: SOLD ON THE THRIFT SHOP FLOOR It is good enough to sell locally. Somebody buys it and wears it again. This is the best outcome for the garment.

CARD: BALED AND SOLD TO A DEALER It is packed into a bale with hundreds of other garments, sold by weight to a used-clothing dealer, and often shipped to another country to be sold there.

CARD: CUT INTO WIPING RAGS It cannot be sold as clothing. It is cut into rags for factories, garages, and shops. The material still does a job, but it is worth less than it was.

CARD: SHREDDED INTO FIBER It is shredded back into loose fiber and used for insulation, carpet padding, or stuffing. The material survives. The garment does not.

CARD: LANDFILL OR BURNED Nobody will take it. It goes to a landfill or is burned. This is the end of the road.

Put the cards in order

Write the order your station chose:

Which cards are the end of the road? _____

Which card does a shirt with a cracked graphic and a hole in it reach first? _____

The corrected path (copy from the board)

WORN → _____ → _____ → then one of: _____ , _____ , _____ , or _____

Page 3. Day 1: the numbers, and how to read a number

The four questions to ask about any number

1. Who published it?
2. What year is the data from?
3. What exactly does it count?
4. What does it not tell you?

The fact table

The number	Source	Year of the data	One thing it does NOT tell you
About 17 million tons of textiles entered the United States municipal solid waste stream in one year. About 11.3 million tons of that was landfilled. About 2.5 million tons was recycled, which is a recycling rate of about 15 percent.	US Environmental Protection Agency, Facts and Figures about Materials, Waste and Recycling	2018 data (published 2020).	
A commonly cited estimate says it takes roughly 1,800 to 2,000 gallons of water to produce one pair of cotton jeans, counting the water to grow the cotton and to make the fabric.	Widely repeated; versions of it appear in United Nations Environment Programme materials and in many news articles.	Varies by source	
One study reported that the average number of times a garment is worn before it stops being used fell by about 36 percent over fifteen years.	Ellen MacArthur Foundation, A New Textiles Economy	2017.	
Where a donated	No single reliable	Varies	

garment goes: sold locally, baled and exported, cut into wiping rags, shredded into fiber, or landfilled. The share going to each path is different for every charity, every sorting center, and every year.	national percentage. **If you see a percentage on a poster with no source, that is the point of this exercise.**		

Which number would you use if you had to convince a parent? _____

Why that one? _____

The four things a person can actually do

Move	One concrete example	Have I done it?
1. Buy less and better		
2. Care for what you have		
3. Repair		
4. Pass it on		

My commitment line: the move I will actually make this month is _____ and I will do it on _____.

Exit card (Day 1)

3 features of fast fashion: _____ , _____ , _____

2 places a donated sweatshirt can end up: _____ , _____

1 move from the four that you will make, and when: _____

Page 4. Day 2: the Consumer Comparison Task

This is a graded check. 20 minutes. You work alone. 10 points.

My clothing decision: I need _____ because _____

Who it is for: _____ **How often it will be worn:** _____

	Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
What it is and where from (vendor type)			
Price	$	$	$
Extra costs (shipping, return, tax)	$	$	$
Total the buyer pays	$	$	$
My estimate of times worn			
Cost per wear (show the division)			
One quality check and what I found			
One sustainability consideration			

My recommendation: I recommend option _____ , which is _____ .

My reason, naming the buyer and the use: _____

The option that came second, and why it lost: _____

Sentence frames

- I recommend option ___ because ___.
- Option ___ costs $___ per wear, and option ___ costs $___ per wear.
- One quality check I would run is ***, and a good result is*** .
- One sustainability consideration is ___.
- Option ___ lost because ___.

The sample row (fill this in while the teacher models it)

The teacher's decision: sneakers for gym class.

	Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
What it is and where from	$30 discount pair	$75 brand pair	$18 secondhand pair
Times worn (estimate)			
Cost per wear			
Quality check			
Sustainability consideration			

Five default decisions, if you cannot think of one

1. A winter coat. 2. Sneakers. 3. Jeans. 4. A sweatshirt for school. 5. A dress or a button shirt for a family event.

One season, one budget (do this with the teacher, before the 20 minutes start)

A comparison picks one item. A budget decides how much money there is before anything gets picked. The amount comes first. The list comes second. The last line is what got cut.

This box is checked complete, partial, or missing for daily work. It is not part of the 10 points.

The amount I have for clothes for one season: $_____ (one season is about three months)

What I actually need for that season. Write the item, then your best estimate of what it costs.

#	What I need	What I think it costs
1		$

2		$
3		$
4		$
	Total	**$**

Does the total fit inside the amount? Circle one: YES / NO

If it does not fit, what comes off the list, and why that one and not another:

One thing I already own, or could repair, that covers a line on this list:

Closure line (back of this page)

The hardest part of this comparison was _____ , because _____.

Page 5. The printed scoring checklist (read it before you start)

Consumer Comparison Task, 10 points. Topic 5.3 formal check.

#	What it takes	Points	Mine (self-check)	Teacher
1	Three options are named, and each one says what kind of place it comes from (discount store, mall brand, secondhand, online, or "repair or reuse what I own")	2	[ ]	___ / 2
2	A price is given for each option, and any extra cost (shipping, return, tax) is added in to a total	1	[ ]	___ / 1
3	Cost per wear is computed for all three options, with the division shown and the unit written (dollars per wear)	2	[ ]	___ / 2
4	One quality check is named for each option, from the five factors in Lesson 5.13, with what a good result looks like	2	[ ]	___ / 2
5	One	1	[ ]	___ / 1

	sustainability consideration is named, and it is specific (not “it is bad for the planet”)			
6	A recommendation names one option and gives a reason that names the buyer and the use, and the runner-up is named with why it lost	2	[ ]	___ / 2

Total: _____ / 10

Teacher note on the total line: _____

Reduced version (2 options instead of 3): items 1, 3, 4, and 6 are scored on two options instead of three, at the same point values. The reduction is written on this line and does not lower the score: _____